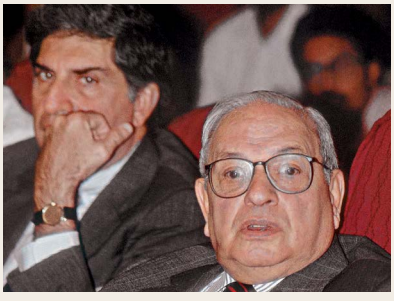
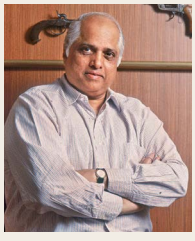


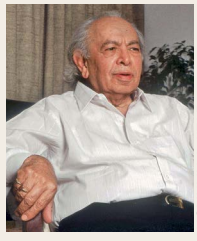
1991 Succeeds JRD Tata as Chairman of Tata Sons and Tata Trusts

1992-97 Removes three satraps (*clockwise, below*) Russi Mody of Tata Steel, Darbari Seth of Tata Chemicals and Ajit Kerkar of Indian Hotels to modernise Tata Group

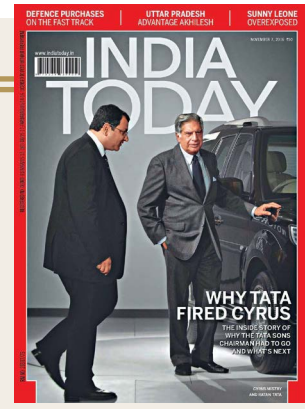


HEMANT PITHWA





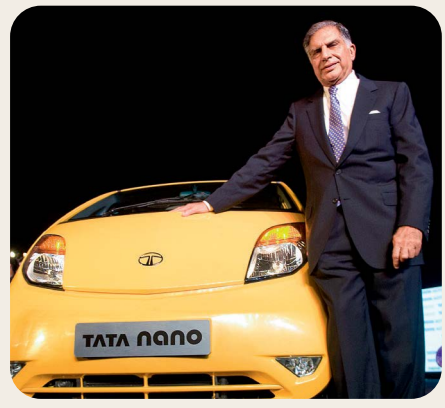
DILIP PRAKASH



2016 Mistry is removed as Chairman

2012 Steps down as Executive Chairman of Tata Sons, making way for Cyrus Mistry

2009 Launches the Tata Nano



UMESH GOSWAMI

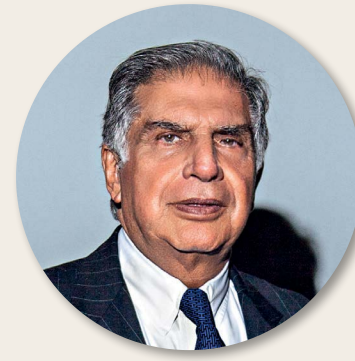
2008 Acquires Jaguar-Land Rover from Ford Motor Company in a $2.3 billion deal

2007 Acquires European steel giant Corus for $13 billion

2000 Acquires the Tetley Tea Company for $440 million

2016-2017 Serves as Interim Chairman

2021 The Supreme Court rules in favour of Ratan Tata and Tata Sons in the removal of Cyrus Mistry



THE MAKING OF A GLOBAL GIANT

Tata Group's turnover

$4 bn
When Tata took over in 1991

$100 bn
When Tata retired in 2012

$165 bn
Turnover in 2024

group nimble-footed and competitive. So, Tata sold off underperforming sectors like textiles, pharmaceuticals, cosmetics and cement, and accorded a big push to software and steel and other new-age businesses. Of that phase, reminiscing to INDIA TODAY, Tata had these wry words to offer: "People say I am soft but yet I get accused of pushing older people out, having dark sides, selling companies and doing all those things which are not soft."

Once the group consolidation was in place, Tata executed a massive phase of expansion, straddling several key sectors. On the domestic front, he executed some audacious business plans that included the forays into telecom, retail and finance, the creation of the first indigenous car Indica, the launch of the cheapest car Nano and the re-entry of the group into aviation through tie-ups with Singapore Airlines and Malaysia's Air Asia, among others.

> "If somebody puts a gun to my head, you either pull the trigger or you take your gun away because I will not move my head"
>
> **— on Singur controversy, 2008**

On the international front, Tata aggressively acquired prized compa-